

BODY DECODE • FOUR PATTERNS

The Order

Which correction goes with which. And why the sequence matters more than the correction.

Four patterns, four different corrections. Running the wrong one is why plans half work.

But there is a step before that, and it is the one almost everyone skips. **The corrections only work in a body that can currently use them.** Get the sequence wrong and even the right correction does nothing, which is how people conclude that the approach failed when the order failed.

The sequence

1. **Read the state.** What is this body currently doing. Not what plan does it want.
2. **Bring the foundation up.** Sleep, fuel, load. Whatever is on the floor comes off the floor first.
3. **Correct the pattern.** Only now does the pattern-specific work do anything.

THE SIGNAL THAT DECIDES IT

Skip step one and steps two and three are guesswork.

Skip step two and step three lands on a body that cannot spend on adaptation, so it turns your effort into fatigue instead of change. A body in protection mode does not respond to a better program. It responds to the threat coming down. That is not a mindset point, it is an energy-availability one.

1 Stress-Stored • cortisol

Where it holds: the front of the middle, while arms and legs stay lean.

What it answers to: load coming down and sleep being protected.

What makes it worse: more training, and cutting food harder. Both read as further threat to a body already defending itself, and it holds tighter. This is the pattern where a good week tempts you to add a fourth hard session, and that is precisely the wrong move.

The counter-intuitive bit. On this one the plan should often go down, not up.

2 Insulin-Drift • insulin

Where it holds: mid-back, lower back and the flanks, with the front comparatively flat.

What it answers to: meal timing, and what sits alongside the carbohydrate.

What makes it worse: nothing dramatic, which is the trap. This is the one pattern where eating less and moving more is genuinely fair, so a generic plan half works, and the half-result convinces you the plan was right and you were the problem.

The counter-intuitive bit. Cutting carbs out is not the lever. Timing and pairing move this more reliably, and they are survivable past a fortnight.

3 Estrogen-Shift · oestrogen · women

Where it holds: hips, glutes and outer thighs, and later it starts moving toward the middle.

What it answers to: consistent fuelling.

What makes it worse: restriction. It reads as scarcity, the body conserves harder, and the harder you push the tighter the hold. This is the pattern where the standard advice is not merely ineffective, it is actively counterproductive.

The counter-intuitive bit. This one has two phases that look different and take different handling. Storage at the hips with regular cycles is one thing. That same fat redistributing centrally while lean mass falls is another. Cycle status and direction of travel decide it, not the location.

4 Androgen-Divine · testosterone · men

Where it holds: it is not a location. The middle fills while muscle, tone and drive fall together.

What it answers to: protecting muscle first.

What makes it worse: aggressive dieting. It costs you the muscle you were trying to protect, and less muscle means more conversion of testosterone in fat tissue, which means less testosterone, which means more fat. The diet feeds the problem.

The counter-intuitive bit. The read is the muscle going, not the fat arriving. Fat gain on its own does not type this.

Why running the wrong one is expensive

YOU RUN	CORTISOL PATTERN	INSULIN PATTERN	OESTROGEN PATTERN	TESTOSTERONE PATTERN
Harder training	Worse. Adds threat.	Some effect.	Worse if fuelling drops with it.	Depends entirely on whether muscle is protected.
Aggressive calorie cut	Worse. Another stressor.	Works, then stalls.	Worse. Reads as scarcity.	Worse. Costs the muscle.
Carb elimination	Little effect, and cuts fuel further.	Half works, then returns.	Worse when it drops total fuel.	Little effect on the actual driver.
Load down, sleep protected	The correction.	Neutral to helpful.	Helpful.	Helpful.

Read the bottom row against the top three. **The advice that fixes one pattern actively makes two others worse.** That is not a discipline problem. It is a targeting problem, and no amount of trying harder solves it.

This is a map, not a verdict. A pattern is a read, and a read can change as the body changes. If nothing here fits cleanly, that is a real answer rather than a failure, and a body that is genuinely responding well will not type at all.

Do not run a correction off a guess. The whole point of the sequence is that step three is cheap and effective once steps one and two are done, and expensive and pointless before that. Picking the closest-looking pattern from a page and going straight to its correction is the same mistake in a new outfit.

WANT TO KNOW WHICH ONE IS YOURS?

The free **14-day Body Decode Challenge** takes an intake on day zero, scores eight markers against your own baseline on day seven, and gives you the full pattern read on day fourteen.

Which of the four is running yours, and what that specific one answers to.

Free. Nothing to pay to get the read.

bodyrecode.au/challenge